



LAKEWOOD CITY COUNCIL MINUTES

Monday, July 20, 2026

City of Lakewood

6000 Main Street SW

Lakewood, WA 98499

<https://www.youtube.com/user/cityoflakewoodwa>

Telephone via Zoom: +1(253) 215-8782

Participant ID: 868 7263 2373

CALL TO ORDER

COUNCILMEMBER PEARSON MOVED TO NOMINATE COUNCILMEMBER LAURICELLA TO BE PRESIDING OFFICER FOR TONIGHT'S MEETING. SECONDED BY COUNCILMEMBER TALBO. VOICE VOTE TAKEN. UNANIMOUS VOTE.

Presiding Officer Lauricella called the meeting to order at 6:02 p.m.

ROLL CALL

Councilmembers Present: 5 – Councilmembers Ellen Talbo, Michael Brandstetter, Philip Lindholm, Ryan Pearson and J. Trestin Lauricella.

Councilmembers Excused: 2 – Mayor Paul Bocchi and Deputy Mayor Patti Belle.

PLEDGE OF ALLEGIANCE

Presiding Officer Lauricella led the Pledge of Allegiance.

PUBLIC COMMENTS

Judith, Lakewood Resident, spoke about City of Lakewood, climate change and American Lake water quality.

Ken, Tacoma Resident, spoke about Lochburn Lane and speed limit on this street.

Tichomir Dunlop, Lakewood Resident, spoke about Dower Elementary and Garry Oak Trees.

Linda Smith, Lakewood Resident, spoke about local businesses and the Custer Road Project.

Kathy Hart, Lakewood Resident, spoke about Edgewater Park and noise levels in their neighborhood. She also spoke about parking issues from residents parking in their neighborhood to access Edgewater Park.

James Dunlop, Lakewood Resident, spoke about Garry Oak trees within the City of Lakewood.

Paul Brice, Lakewood Resident, spoke about Cannabis regulations within the City of Lakewood.

Christina Manetti, Lakewood Resident, spoke about the John Dower Road project and Garry Oak tree removals.

Christina Manetti, Garry Oak Coalition, provided donated copies of the book, "Nature of Oaks" written by Douglas W. Tallamy. She also read a letter from the author regarding Garry Oak Tree Removal within the City of Lakewood.

Corey Camble, Lakewood Resident, spoke about the Custer Road Project and local businesses.

Haley Ivy, Lakewood Resident, spoke about Edgewater Park conditions.

Ebrahim Mirjalili, Lakewood Resident, spoke about John Dower Street and future tree removal.

C O N S E N T A G E N D A

- A. Approval of the minutes of the City Council meeting of July 6, 2026.
- B. Approval of the minutes of the City Council meeting of July 13, 2026.
- C. Motion No. 2026-50

Authorizing the execution of an interlocal agreement with Pierce County for on-call building inspection services.

D. Motion No. 2026-51

Authorizing the execution of an amendment to the agreement with Graham Baba Architects, in the amount of \$177, 243, for updated design, bidding and other support services for the H-Barn Redevelopment.

E. Motion No. 2026-52

Authorizing the execution of an agreement with MacDonald Miller, in the amount of \$75,177, for Energy Planning, Reporting and Monitoring associated with the State Clean Building Act Compliance.

F. Motion No. 2026-53

Accepting a grant from the Washington State Department of Commerce Defense Community Compatibility Account (DCCA), in the amount of \$873,000, for the North Clear Zone Project demolition of Tactical Tailor building.

G. Motion No. 2026-54

Accepting a grant from the Office of Public Defense, in the amount of \$5,000, for public defense services.

H. Items filed in the Office of the City Clerk:

1. Lakewood's Promise Advisory Board meeting minutes of February 5, 2026.
2. Parks and Recreation Advisory Board meeting of April 28, 2026.
3. Parks and Recreation Advisory Board meeting of May 26, 2026.

COUNCILMEMBER PEARSON MOVED TO ADOPT THE CONSENT AGENDA. SECONDED BY COUNCILMEMBER BRANDSTETTER. VOICE VOTE WAS TAKEN AND CARRIED UNANIMOUSLY.

R E G U L A R A G E N D A

UNFINISHED BUSINESS

None.

NEW BUSINESS

None.

ITEMS FOR DISCUSSION

Review of 2nd Quarter (2026) Police Report and Fireworks Calls for Service.

Chief Patrick Smith presented a review of the 2nd quarter Police Report. He reported the Lakewood Police Department has a 5.6% reduction in Calls for Service and a 2% reduction in Sex Crimes.

Chief Patrick Smith also presented a review of Fireworks Calls for Service for 2026.

Downtown Transportation Feasibility Study: Status Update & Preliminary Alternatives.

Assistant Director of Planning and Public Works Angie Silva shared a PowerPoint presentation outlining the Downtown Transportation Feasibility Study. She provided an overview of the survey results, preliminary alternatives and timeline of the Downtown Transportation Feasibility.

Review of Automated Traffic Safety Camera Program.

City Attorney Heidi Ann Wachter was joined by Captain Peter Johnson to provide an overview of the Automated Traffic Safety Camera Program.

REPORTS BY THE CITY MANAGER

City Manager Russell reported needing schedule availability from Councilmembers for the Legislative Update meeting.

He announced the following upcoming meetings and events:

- July 21, 2026, 6:30 p.m. Oakbrook Neighborhood Association Meeting
- July 23, 2026, 11 a.m. Kendrick Landing Apartments Blue Ribbon opening
- July 29, 2026, 6 p.m. Desserts in Driveway Oakbrook

CITY COUNCIL COMMENTS

Councilmember Brandstetter stated he will attend the Kendrick Landing Apartments Blue Ribbon opening.

Councilmember Talbo reported she will attend the Oakbrook Neighborhood Association meeting, the Kendrick Landing Apartments Blue Ribbon opening and the APCC 16th Annual Samoa Community Banquet and Awards Night. Councilmember Talbo suggested updates to the City's website for better transparency involving the Custer Road Project.

Councilmember Lindholm thanked his fellow Councilmembers for their discussion at tonight's meeting.

Councilmember Pearson reported he will attend the Sewer General Plan Review Committee meeting, the MBA Ride around the County and the Puget Sound Regional Council meeting.

Councilmember Lauricella addressed tonight's public comments and supported Talbo's request regarding Custer Road Project and website correspondence.

ADJOURNMENT

There being no further business, the meeting adjourned at 9:03 p.m.

 J. Trestin Lauricella (Aug 5, 2026 00:04:16 PDT)

J. TRESTIN LAURICELLA, PRESIDING OFFICER

ATTEST:



JOSIE ATKINS
ACTING CITY CLERK